

Useful insects

Here are some other ways that insects are useful to us.

Red food dye: this food colouring is made from the bodies of scale insects.



Silk: believe it or not, the silk you wear is made by silk-moth caterpillars!



Honey: if there were no bees in the world, we would have no honey.



Food: to some people, such as the Australian aborigines, grubs are a meal.



As old as an insect

We know that insects were around 40 million years ago because some were trapped in a tree resin called amber, which hardened back then and preserved them.

Pest control

Sometimes insects, such as aphids, eat huge amounts of our crops. The best way to get rid of them is to introduce another insect that likes to eat them. Ladybirds are often used for aphid pest control.

Introducing insects that eat other insects is called biological pest control.

Aphid

Ladybird

Aphids breed so quickly that it is difficult to control them.

Become an expert

142-143 The world of non-insects

152-153 Micro life